



Parks Board October 18 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=i0cG2YXb6Ek
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Muncie Parks and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Tuesday, October 18, 2022

Report Prepared By: Expert Civic Analyst

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Brad Marshall called the Muncie Parks and Recreation Board meeting to order on Tuesday, October 18, 2022.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** James Letton, Shannon Powers, Mark Irving, Brad Marshall (Presiding Officer).
 - **Members Absent:** (None explicitly stated as absent on roll call).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The board noted that minutes from the September meeting were unavailable for review and would be added to the agenda for the December meeting.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:15:45 Southside Neighborhood Association Event Application**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Courtney Marsh, President of the Southside Neighborhood Association.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Marsh presented an upcoming free community event featuring basketball, kickball, and participation from local police and sheriff department officers to foster positive community-police interactions. No money will be exchanged. Board members questioned the lack of prior approval before advertising, but staff and the board agreed to move forward.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **00:19:15 Emerson Doll Park Halloween Party Application**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Parks Superintendent (application submitted by Kelly Stewart).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed an application for a dog Halloween party at Emerson Doll Park scheduled for October 30th from 12:00 PM to 4:00 PM. Discussion focused on ensuring water availability and porta-potties despite seasonal shut-offs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **01:05:35 Bridge Community Church Event Application**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Zach Bowe, Bridge Community Church.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Bowe presented an application for a community event on October 29th from 6:00 PM to 8:00 PM at Cooley Park, featuring a children's costume parade, free food, pumpkin activities, and a screening of *It's the Great Pumpkin, Charlie Brown*. Expected attendance is 50 to 100 people.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **01:16:58 Tuohy Pool Slide Repair Funding Allocation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shannon Powers (Board Member) / Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Powers reported that grinding and sanding revealed the initial \$10,000 quote (funded by a Kitzelman Grant) for Tuohy Pool slide repairs was insufficient to prevent brittleness. The revised professional restoration cost is \$20,000. Powers requested allocating \$10,000 from the mayor's bond fund to cover the deficit, noting that a brand-new replacement slide would cost approximately \$150,000.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to allocate \$10,000 from bond funds for slide repairs.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:23:19 Michael Anderson**

Expressed strong concern regarding a short-notice letter received on October 11th requiring 11 campers to remove structures/campers for site inspections and maintenance. Stated that managing 50 customer boats at his private storage business makes the 15-to-30-day timeline impossible, and requested a timeline extending to the first of the year.

- **01:31:02 Linda Shoemaker**

Expressed appreciation for the campground, praising staff (Ashley Wright and Dustin Clark) for keeping the park well-maintained and urging community cooperation.

- **01:32:13 Dorothea Meadows**

Inquired about the lack of specific notification forms for campers asked to clear sites for inspection versus those offered winter storage, and asked for advance notice on future rate adjustments.

- **01:36:42 Joanne Hammond**

Addressed tree removal notices affecting her campsite, noting that an independent tree specialist inspected her trees and found them healthy with no urban forestry markings, and questioned potential conflicts of interest among board members.

- **01:43:32 Mary Sexton**

Stated that receiving a removal notice in October giving 30 days to clear long-standing improvements and fifth-wheel campers is an unreasonable hardship given winter weather, lack of towing vehicles, and health issues.

- **01:48:29 Leonard Lewis**

Expressed frustration regarding historical difficulties in obtaining campsite spots through lotteries and suggested broader communication of park rule changes to all leaseholders.

- **01:52:48 Russell Morris**

Addressed the cancellation of the annual haunted trail event, defending his electrical setups as low-voltage (20-amp GFI extension cords) run via video surveillance, and criticized park management for unfair treatment and short-notice campsite clearance orders.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- **Prairie Creek & Parks Reports:** Updates provided on Ironman success, beach sand replenishment, upcoming floating dock installations (phased over 3 years), and

proposed 2023 rate structures (seasonal sites, nightly camping, and mooring/pier fees) introduced for review ahead of a December vote.

- **Special Work Session Scheduled:** The board agreed to notice a public work session later in the week (earliest Friday, adhering to 48-hour notice rules) to meet with Prairie Creek staff (Dustin Clark and Ashley Wright) to discuss camper grievances, tree maintenance notices, and timeline concerns.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned without a scheduled November meeting date; the next regular meeting is set for December 20, 2022.

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